

## RESPONSE PAPER

Data accumulated throughout history for reasons such as governance, population tracking, or taxation has reached an enormous scale, speed, and structural complexity, especially in the last quarter century, opening the doors to the big data era. While the classical perspective views data as an objective, "raw" reality, the critical data perspective challenges this idea, arguing that the term "raw data" is inherently contradictory and that all data is actually processed and refined through specific intentions and filters. According to the authors, data is the result of multi-dimensional socio-technical structures, known as data assemblages, where economic interests, legal frameworks, practical applications, and philosophical foundations converge. Parallel to Foucault's relationship between knowledge and power, these structures not only depict the current state of the world but also act as powerful tools dictating which questions should be asked and how the produced knowledge should govern society.

How these data structures transform social life is grounded in the looping effect proposed by philosopher Ian Hacking. This concept refers to the mechanism by which the categories and classifications created by systems reshape and, in effect, "reinvent" the people and phenomena they measure. Individuals are evaluated in light of this data, new social standards are established, and institutions make bureaucratic decisions based on these new rules. However, the infiltration of big data into every aspect of daily life brings with it serious dangers. The tracking of people's digital footprints by states and commercial organizations (dataveillance), the use of profiles derived from this tracking to subject individuals to social sorting, and the preemptive treatment of individuals for potential actions they haven't yet committed (anticipatory governance) are prime examples of this bleak picture.

In addition, "control creep," which refers to the process of data collected for a specific and limited purpose being taken out of context and used for entirely different surveillance and profiling activities, clearly violates the "data minimization" principle that defends the privacy of individuals. All these emerging ethical issues and algorithmic discriminations prove the importance of Critical Data Studies, which examines the intentions of those who control data and how these systems change cities/spaces. The authors suggest that to fully understand these control mechanisms in the digital age, theoretical discussions alone should be avoided; instead, emphasis should be placed on empirical field research based on concrete data collection, such as participant observation, in-depth interviews, and ethnography. Looking at the text in general, the following questions come to mind:

1. How can we prevent the algorithmic "anticipatory governance" systems used by security forces to predict potential crimes and criminals from violating universal and

fundamental legal principles such as the “presumption of innocence” by punishing people based on potential behaviors they haven’t yet acted upon?

2. In today’s system, where information has become a commercial commodity and data collected for innocent purposes is constantly evolving into different surveillance tools through the “control creep” mechanism; To what extent are the rights and privacy of ordinary individuals protected under current legal regulations regarding "data shadows" created in the digital world without their consent?

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